Part C: Practical Money Tips for University Students

No matter your archetype, these 9 low-effort micro-habits will help you effortlessly protect your wallet:

1. The Wage-Converter Hack

How it works: Next time you want to buy a $60 jacket, divide the price by your hourly part-time wage (e.g., $10/hr). Ask yourself: "Is this jacket worth standing for 6 hours serving food?" If it hurts, your brain will hit the brakes.

2. Add Digital Friction

How it works: Unlink your credit card from food delivery apps and shopping platforms. Having to physically find your card and type 16 digits when ordering late-night snacks adds enough hassle to eliminate 50% of impulse buys.

3. Lazy Tracking ("Track Big, Ignore Small")

How it works: Stop tracking every $2 drink. Only log fixed expenses and non-essential purchases over $15. Set a weekly cash budget for daily meals (e.g., $100)—when it's gone, wait until next week. Zero tracking fatigue.

4. Maximize Student Privilege

How it works: Turn asking for discounts into muscle memory. Whether buying hardware, transit passes, software, or movie tickets, always ask: "Is there a student discount?" Getting rejected costs nothing; getting a discount is risk-free arbitrage.

5. Separate three kinds of money

How it works: Track cash, reserve and repayments separately. Transfers are not income and borrowing is not earnings.

6. Compare the whole cost

How it works: Compare price, time, usefulness and alternatives. The cheapest choice may not be the best fit.

7. Review subscriptions

How it works: Note the charge date, price, usage and cancellation terms. Consider free alternatives before renewing.

8. Keep a workable backup

How it works: Back up important files and check campus loan resources and support channels before you need them.

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9. My seven-day action

How it works: Choose one action and decide when and how to do it. For example, review one subscription on Wednesday and note its renewal date and fee.

What goal would you like to achieve in the next 7 days?

My goal is:

When will I start, and what is my first step?

How will I know I have achieved my goal?